QUICK-COMMERCE BENCHMARKING

Blinkit vs Zepto vs Swiggy Instamart

Overview | Financial | Supply chain | Unit Economics | Zepto case study | AI Insights | Methodology

Fiscal Year: FY2026

Company: All

orders (mn)
1,969
▲ +89% vs FY2025

Dark Stores
4,525
▲ +1,174 added vs FY2025

Combined adj. EBITDA
-8,830

Best ₹ / order
-3.0

Share of orders (%)

Adjusted EBITDA per order (₹)

Company scorecard · FY2026

Company	Growth	Order (mn)	Adj EBITDA	Stores	₹ / order
Blinkit	▲ +116% vs FY2025	917	-277	2,243	-3.02
Instamart	▲ +44% vs FY2025	412	-3,511	1,143	-85.18
Zepto	▲ +93% vs FY2025	640	-5,042	1,139	-78.75

Key insights

Blinkit hit break-even. Adjusted EBITDA turned positive in Q3 and Q4 FY26.
Zepto is closing the gap. Loss per order fell 65%, from ₹171 (Q3 FY25) to ₹59 (Q4 FY26).
Instamart slipped. Loss per order widened to ₹85 in FY26 from ₹73 in FY25.

Source: Zepto UDRHP-I (8 Jun 2026), peer KPI comparison pp.168–174. Revenue not compared across companies due to different business models.

QUICK-COMMERCE BENCHMARKING

Financial performance: revenue and profitability

Fiscal Year: FY2026

Company: All

Overview | Financial | Supply chain | Unit Economics | Zepto case study | AI Insights | Methodology

Blinkit revenue (₹ cr)
37,779
▲ +626% vs FY2025
Not comparable: Blinkit moved to an inventory-led model in Q2 FY26

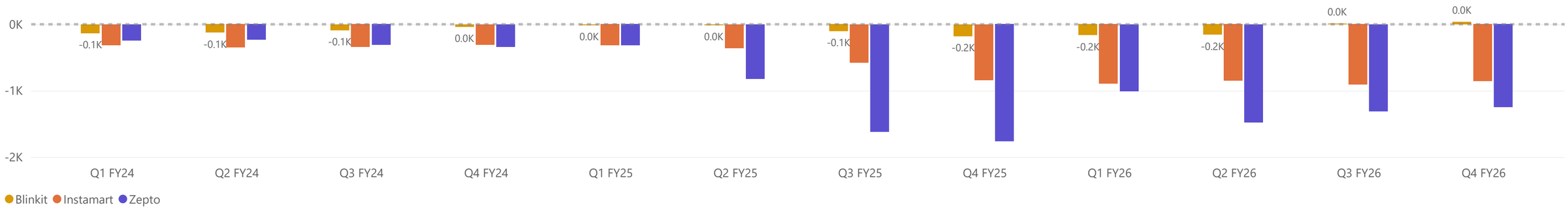
Zepto revenue (₹ cr)
22,624
▲ +104% vs FY2025

Instamart revenue (₹ cr)
3,859
▲ +81% vs FY2025

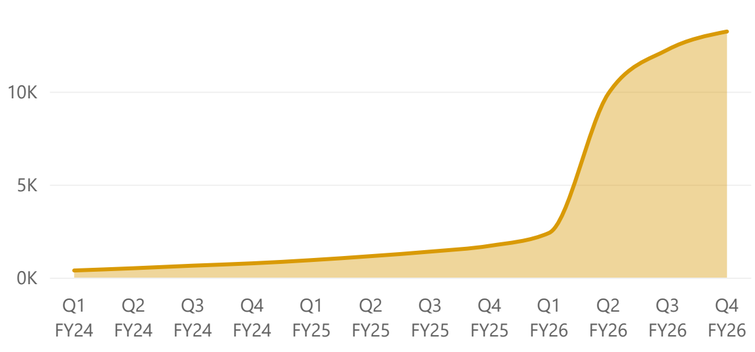
Combined adj. EBITDA
-8,830

Quarterly adjusted EBITDA (₹ crore)

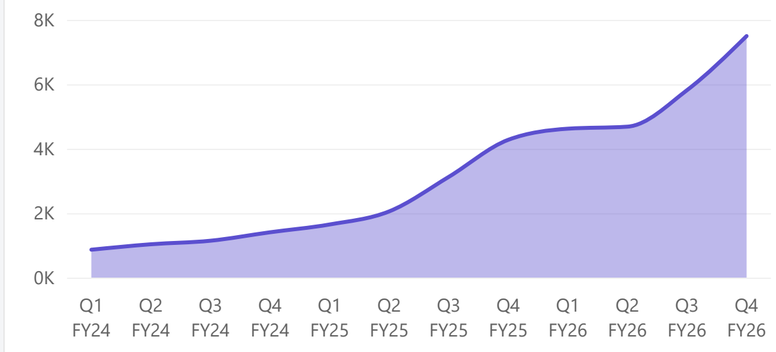
Below zero = operating loss. Blinkit crossed into profit in Q3 FY26



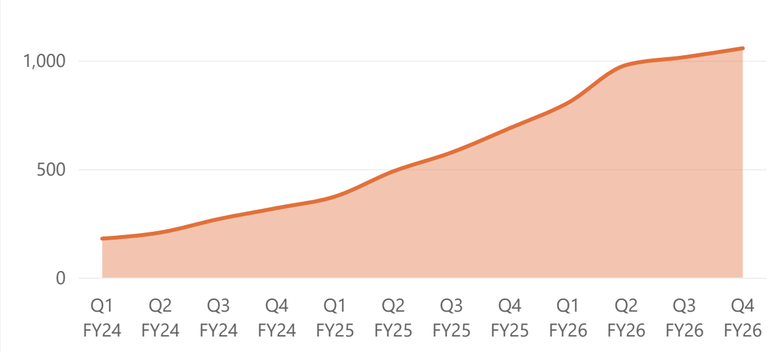
Blinkit revenue (₹ cr)



Zepto revenue (₹ cr)



Instamart revenue (₹ cr)



Source: Zepto UDRHP-I (8 Jun 2026), pp.168–174. Revenue shown per company only — Zepto books full sale value; Blinkit moved to an inventory-led model from Q2 FY26; Instamart books mainly fees.

QUICK-COMMERCE BENCHMARKING

Supply chain: dark-store network and efficiency

Fiscal Year: FY2026

Company: All

Overview | Financial | Supply chain | Unit Economics | Zepto case study | AI Insights | Methodology

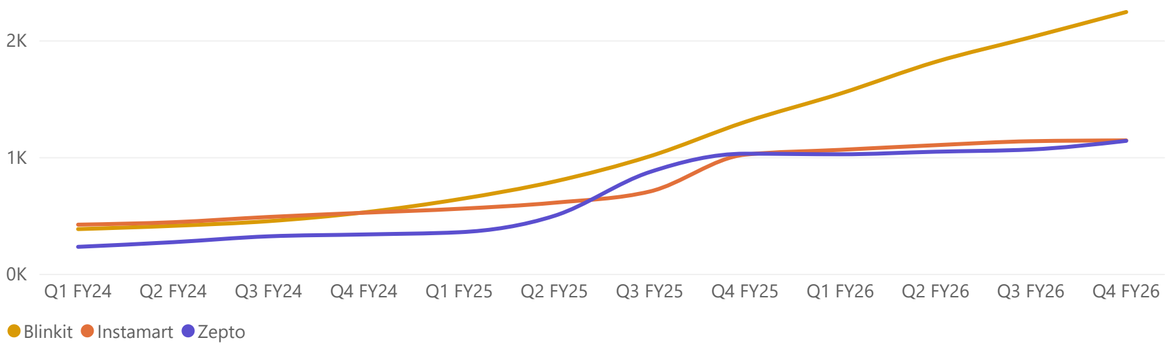
Dark Stores
4,525
▲ +1,174 added vs FY2025

Orders per day (all 3)
6.63 mn
in Q4 FY26

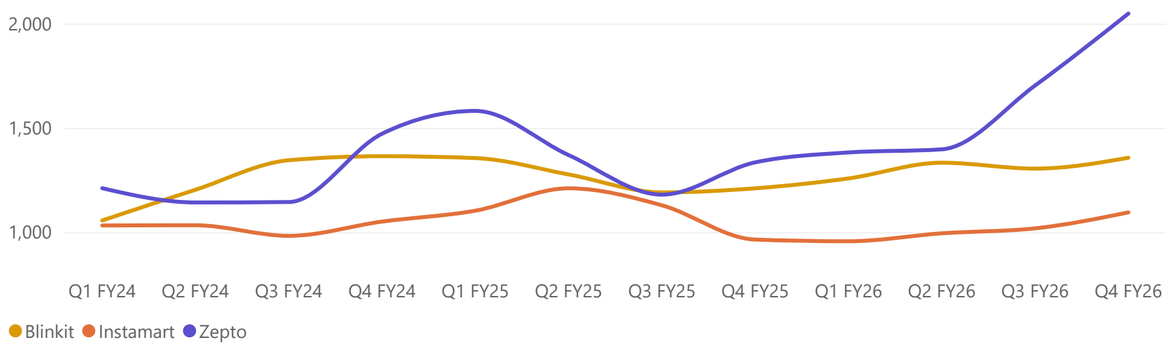
Best order/store/day
2,049
Zepto

Biggest store expansion
Blinkit +942 stores

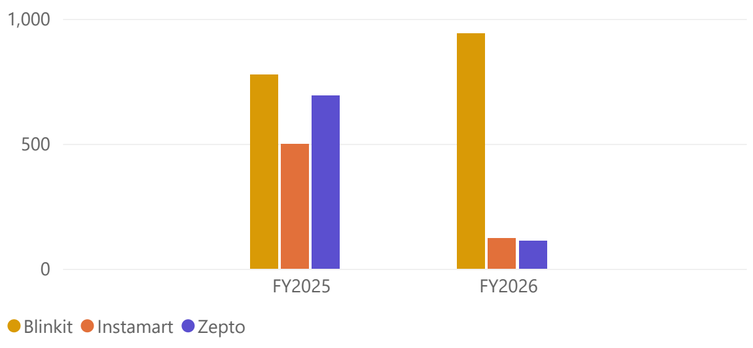
Dark Stores (end of quarter)



Orders per Store per Day



Dark Stores Added per year



Target orders per store
2050

Stores Instamart would need

610

533 fewer than today's 1,143

Key insights

Zepto runs the busiest stores. About 2,050 orders per store per day in Q4 FY26, versus about 1,360 for Blinkit and 1,100 for Instamart.

Blinkit is expanding fastest. It added 942 dark stores in FY26."growing its network by 72% to 2,243"

Zepto paused expansion. It added only 110 stores in FY26 while orders grew 93%, which made each store busier.

Instamart is under-utilised. At Zepto's productivity it would need about 610 stores instead of 1,143 for the same orders.

Source: Zepto UDRHP-I (8 Jun 2026), pp.168–174. Orders per store per day = reported orders per day ÷ closing dark stores (approximation)

QUICK-COMMERCE BENCHMARKING

Unit economics: path to break-even

Fiscal Year: FY2026

Company: All

Overview | Financial | Supply chain | **Unit Economics** | Zepto case study | AI Insights | Methodology

Improve loss per order by (₹)

35

Actual adj.EBITDA (₹ cr)

-8,830

Simulated adj.EBITDA (₹ cr)

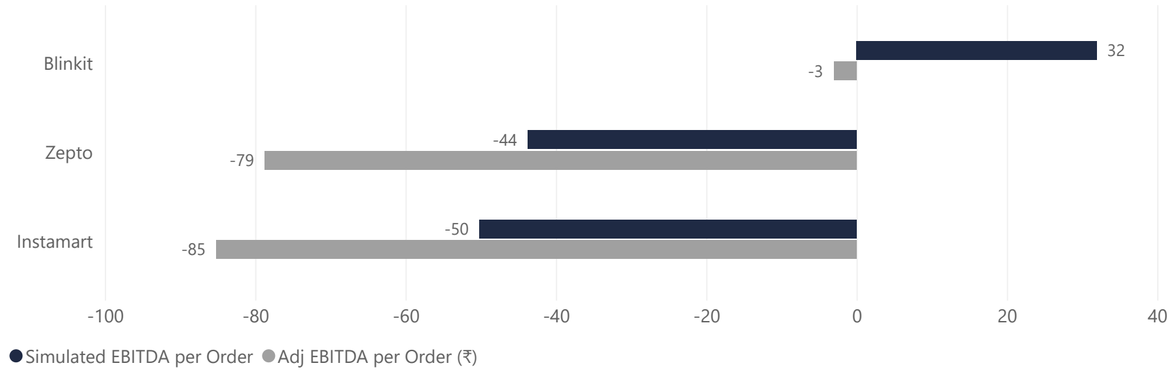
-1,938

₹35 better per order

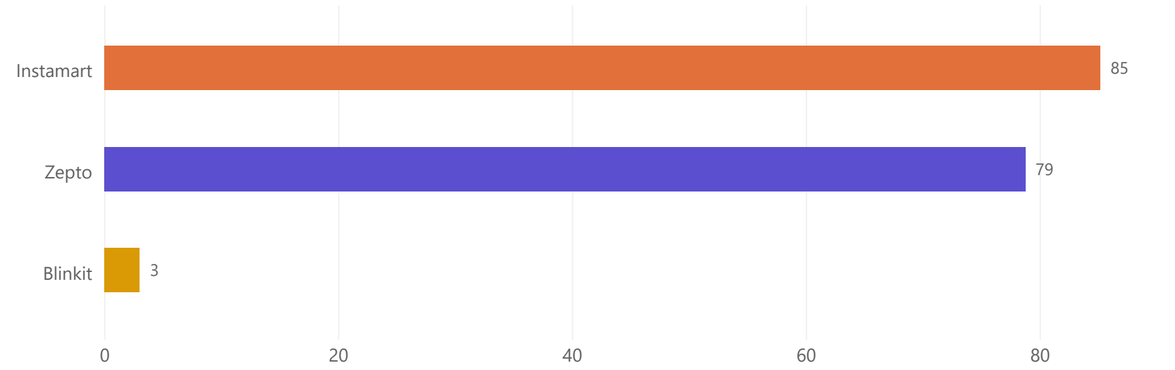
Loss reduced by (₹ cr)

+6,891

Adjusted EBITDA per order (₹): actual vs simulated



Improvement per order needed to break even



Company	Orders (Mn)	Actual ₹/order	Simulated ₹/order	Simulated EBITDA (₹ cr)	Loss reduced (₹ cr)
Blinkit	916.6	-3.02	31.98	2,931.10	3,208.10
Zepto	640.2	-78.75	-43.75	-2,800.96	2,240.60
Instamart	412.2	-85.18	-50.18	-2,068.30	1,442.70
Total	**1,969.0**	**-44.84**	**-9.84**	**-1,938.16**	**6,891.40**

Key insights

Blinkit is ₹3 away from break-even for the full year, and already profitable in Q3 and Q4 FY26.

Zepto needs ₹79 per order. Every ₹10 improvement cuts its annual loss by about ₹640 cr.

Instamart needs ₹85 per order, the largest gap of the three.

Note: *Simulation = actual FY adjusted EBITDA per order + selected improvement × FY orders. Illustrative scenario, not a forecast.*

QUICK-COMMERCE BENCHMARKING

Zepto case study: cost per order

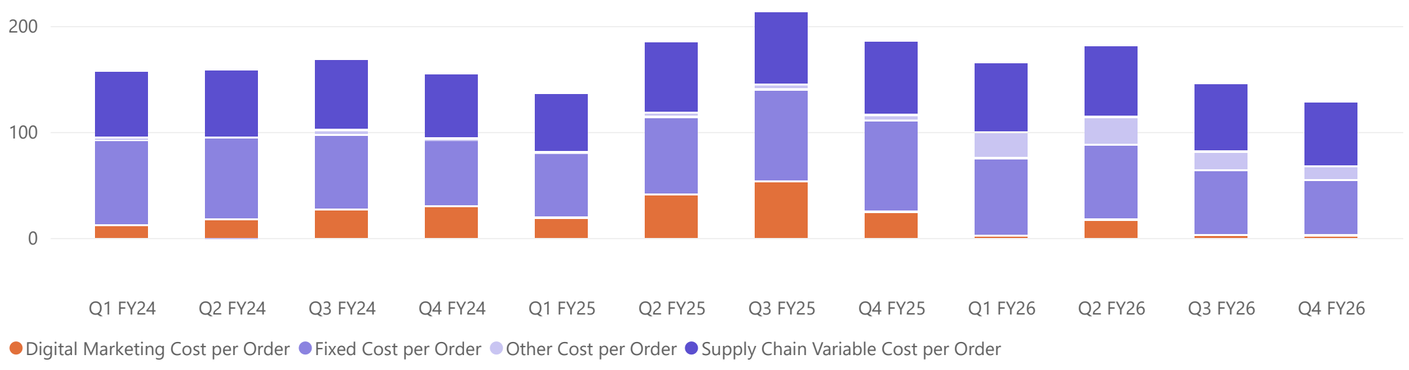
Total cost per order (Q4 FY26)
₹127.8

Marketing cost per order (Q4 FY26)
₹1.0

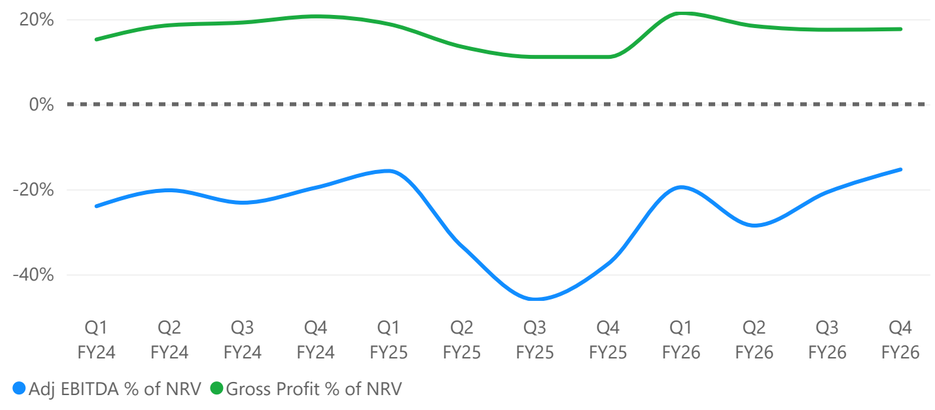
Free cash flow per order (Q4 FY26)
-₹42.0

Inventory days (Q4 FY26)
13.2 days

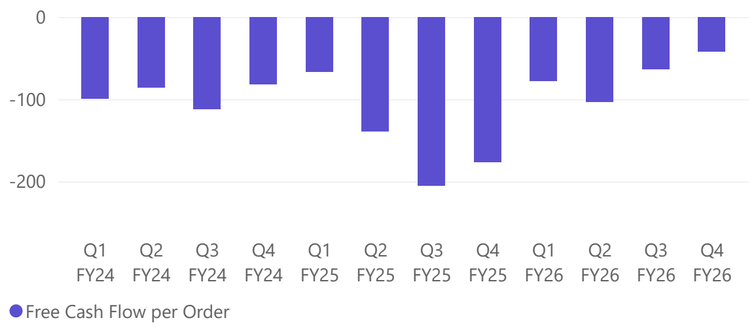
Zepto cost per order breakdown (₹)



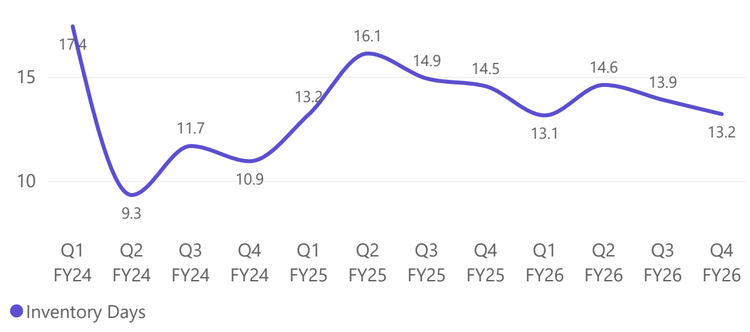
Gross margin and adj. EBITDA margin (% of NRV)



Free cash flow per order (₹)



Inventory days (closing inventory ÷ COGS)



Key insights

Cost per order down 40%: ₹212.6 (Q3 FY25 peak) → ₹127.8 (Q4 FY26).
Marketing was the biggest lever: ₹52.0 → ₹1.0 per order.
Fixed costs spread over more orders: ₹87.0 → ₹52.3 per order.
Supply-chain cost is sticky at ₹61–70 per order since Q2 FY25, the hardest cost to cut.
Cash burn per order fell 80%: −₹204.9 → −₹42.0.

Note: Zepto UDRHP-I (8 Jun 2026) pp.169, 404, 406, 555–556. Zepto only: Blinkit and Instamart do not disclose comparable cost detail. Inventory days and "other cost" are calculated from reported figures.

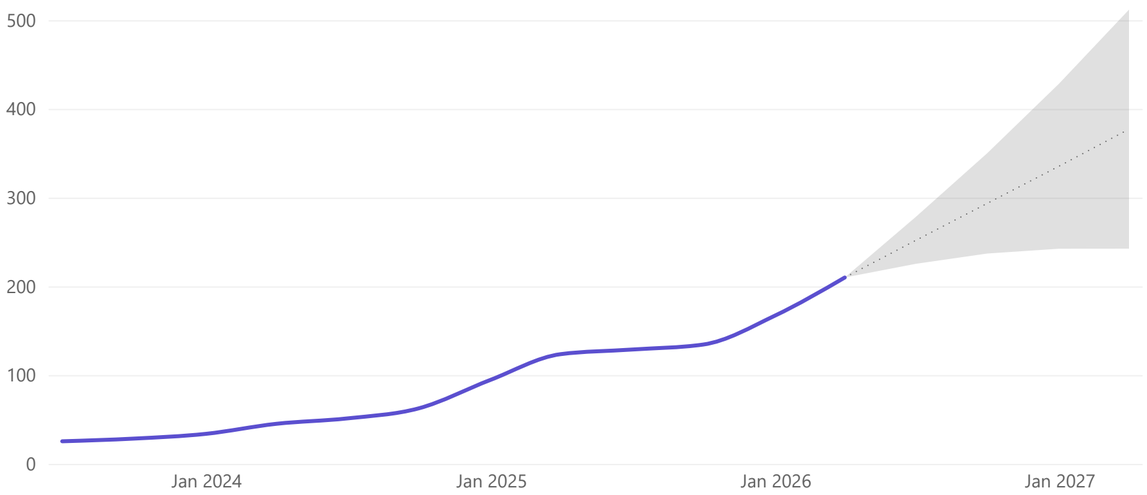
QUICK-COMMERCE BENCHMARKING

AI insights: forecast, anomalies and recommendations

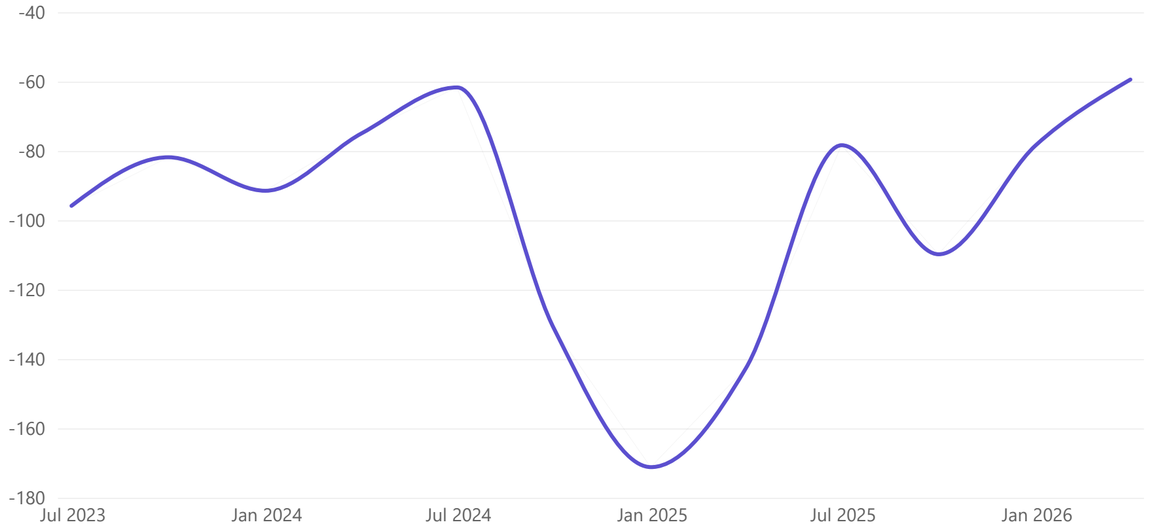
Company: Zepto

Overview | Financial | Supply chain | Unit Economics | Zepto case study | AI Insights | Methodology

Order forecast: next 4 quarters (illustrative)



Zepto loss per order: unusual spike in Q2–Q4 FY25



Recommendations (based on reported data)

1. Instamart: get more orders out of existing stores before opening new ones. In Q4 FY26, Instamart did about 1,095 orders per store per day, compared with about 2,049 for Zepto and about 1,357 for Blinkit.

2. Instamart: close the loss-per-order gap. Adjusted EBITDA per order in FY26 was −₹85.2 for Instamart, against −₹3.0 for Blinkit. Blinkit was EBITDA-positive in Q3 and Q4 FY26, which shows the model can break even at scale.

3. Small improvements per order add up. Every ₹10 saved per order is worth about ₹412 crore a year at Instamart's FY26 volume of 412 million orders (see the simulator on the Unit Economics page).

4. Learn from Zepto's cost cut. Zepto's total cost per order fell from ₹212.6 (Q3 FY25) to ₹127.8 (Q4 FY26), mostly because marketing per order dropped from ₹52.0 to ₹1.0.

5. Keep inventory lean. Zepto held 13.2 inventory days in Q4 FY26. Tracking this along with free cash flow per order shows how fast growth uses up cash.

How AI and analytics were used

1. Forecast (Power BI built-in AI). The order forecast uses Power BI's exponential smoothing model with a 95% confidence band. It projects the trend 4 quarters ahead and is illustrative only, not a company estimate.

2. Anomaly detection (tested). Power BI's built-in anomaly detection was tested on Zepto's loss per order but flagged no points: with only 12 quarters, the model treats the Q2–Q4 FY25 spike (−₹131, −₹171, −₹143 per order) as a trend shift rather than an outlier.

3. What-if simulation. The Unit Economics page tests how much a ₹X saving per order would improve each company's adjusted EBITDA.

4. AI assistant for research. An AI assistant helped locate the KPI tables in Zepto's UDRHP and Eternal's annual report. Every number was checked by hand against the source page before it was used.

What AI was not used for: no data was generated or estimated. All figures are reported company data.

Note: Zepto UDRHP-I (8 Jun 2026), peer KPI tables pp.162–174, 555–556; Eternal Annual Report FY2024-25 p.23. Forecast and anomaly detection use Power BI built-in models. Forecast is illustrative only.

QUICK-COMMERCE BENCHMARKING

Methodology, sources and limitations

Key findings (FY2026)

1. The three platforms delivered 1,969 million orders in FY26, up 89% on FY25, from 4,525 dark stores (1,174 added in the year).
2. Blinkit leads with 46.6% of orders, followed by Zepto at 32.5% and Instamart at 20.9%.
3. Blinkit is closest to break-even at −₹3.0 adjusted EBITDA per order, and was EBITDA-positive in Q3 FY26 (+₹4 cr) and Q4 FY26 (+₹37 cr).
4. Zepto improved the most, from −₹136.2 to −₹78.8 per order. Instamart got worse, from −₹73.4 to −₹85.2.
5. Zepto has the most productive stores: about 2,049 orders per store per day in Q4 FY26, compared with about 1,357 for Blinkit and about 1,095 for Instamart.

Data and sources

- Zepto UDRHP-I (8 June 2026): peer KPI comparison for Blinkit, Zepto and Instamart, Q1 FY24 to Q4 FY26 (pp.162–174).
- Zepto cost per order, cash flow and inventory: UDRHP-I pp.404, 406, 549–550, 555–556.
- Blinkit FY24–FY25 figures cross-checked with the Eternal Annual Report FY2024-25 (p.23).
- 12 quarters × 3 companies. Data was entered in Excel, loaded into Power BI and analysed with DAX measures.
- All figures are reported company data. Nothing is estimated or generated.

How numbers are calculated

- Fiscal year runs April to March (FY26 = Apr 2025 to Mar 2026).
- Adj. EBITDA per order (₹) = Adjusted EBITDA (₹ cr) × 10 ÷ Orders (million).
- Orders per store per day = orders per day in the latest quarter ÷ closing dark stores.
- Growth % = current fiscal year compared with the previous fiscal year.
- Inventory days and “other cost per order” for Zepto are calculated from reported figures.
- What-if simulator: new EBITDA = (EBITDA per order + saving per order) × orders.
- NRV = Net Receivables Value, Zepto’s measure of order value after discounts, plus fees (UDRHP definition).

Limitations

- Revenue is not directly comparable: Zepto reports its own sales, Blinkit moved to an inventory model from Q2 FY26, and Instamart earns mainly fees. Orders and EBITDA per order are used for comparison instead.
- Gross order value and average order value are not published by Zepto, so they are not used.
- Stockouts, wastage and delivery time are not publicly disclosed by any company, so they are not covered.
- Detailed cost, cash flow and inventory data is available for Zepto only.
- Adjusted EBITDA is a company-defined measure and definitions may differ slightly.
- The forecast is illustrative only. Zepto data comes from a draft prospectus and may change.

supply chain KPIs I would track with internal data

Fill rate • Stockout rate by category • Pick and pack time per order • Order-to-door delivery time • Order accuracy • Wastage and shrinkage (fresh produce) • Inventory days by category • Rider orders per hour • Store throughput vs capacity at peak hours

Companies don’t publish these, so they aren’t shown in this dashboard. With internal data they would extend the store-level analysis above.